



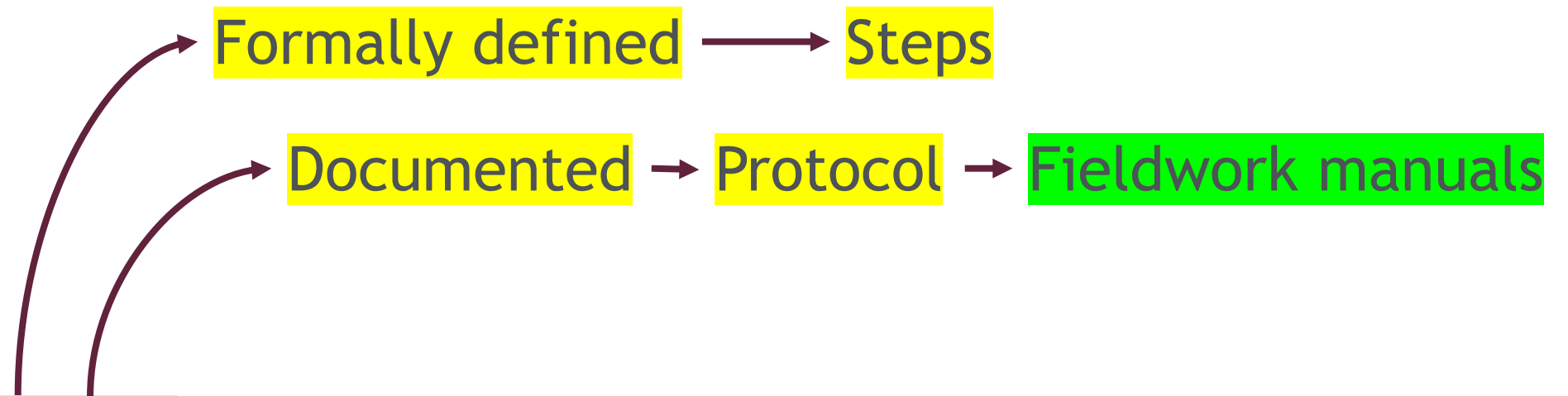
Survey Methods

1.3 - Formalising the survey process

Outline

- Steps in the survey process
- Research questions
- The survey protocol

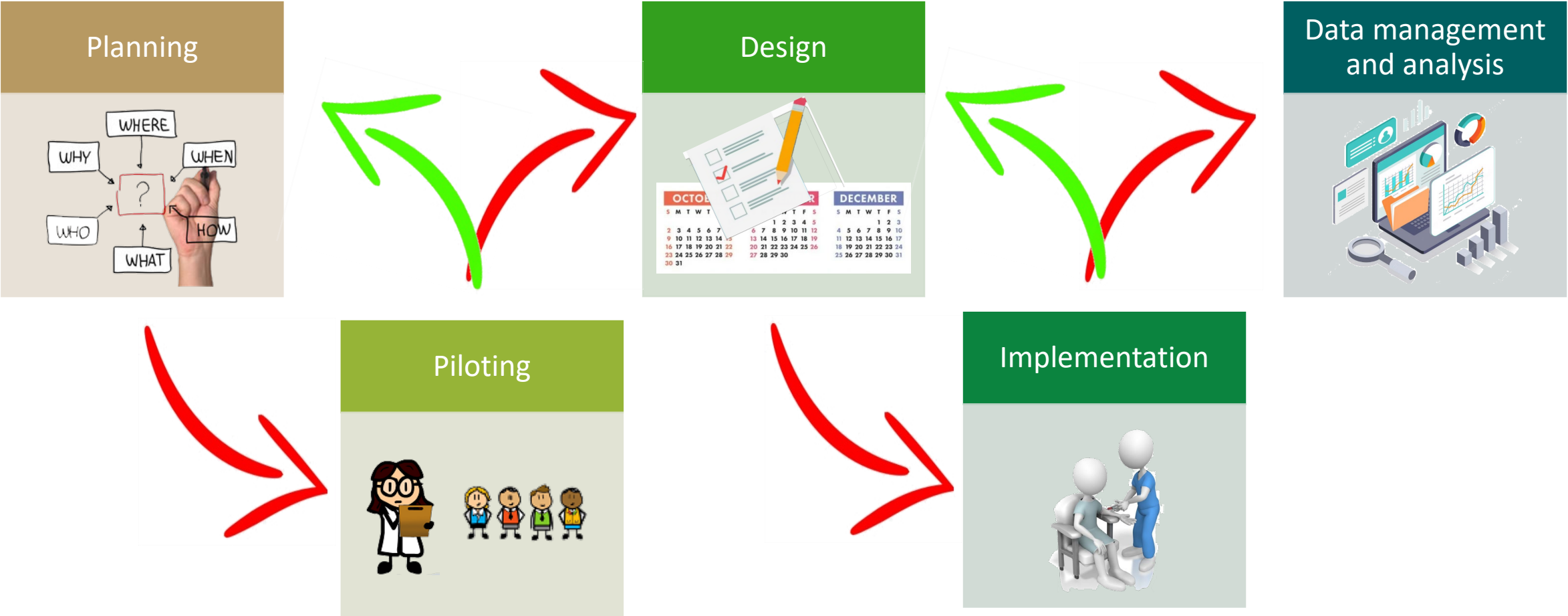
Survey Process



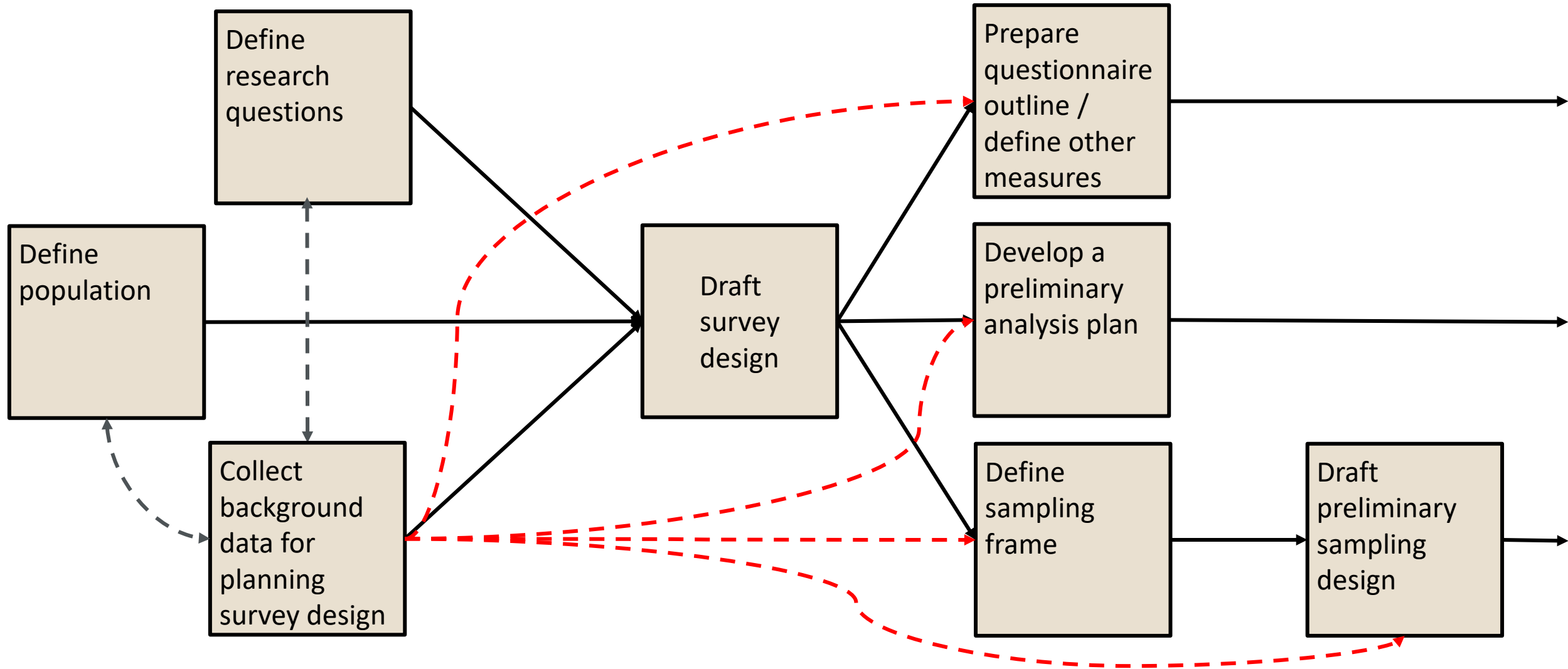
A "survey" is a **systematic** method for gathering information from (a sample of) entities for the purposes of constructing quantitative descriptors of the attributes of the larger population of which the entities are members.

(Groves et al. 2009:3)

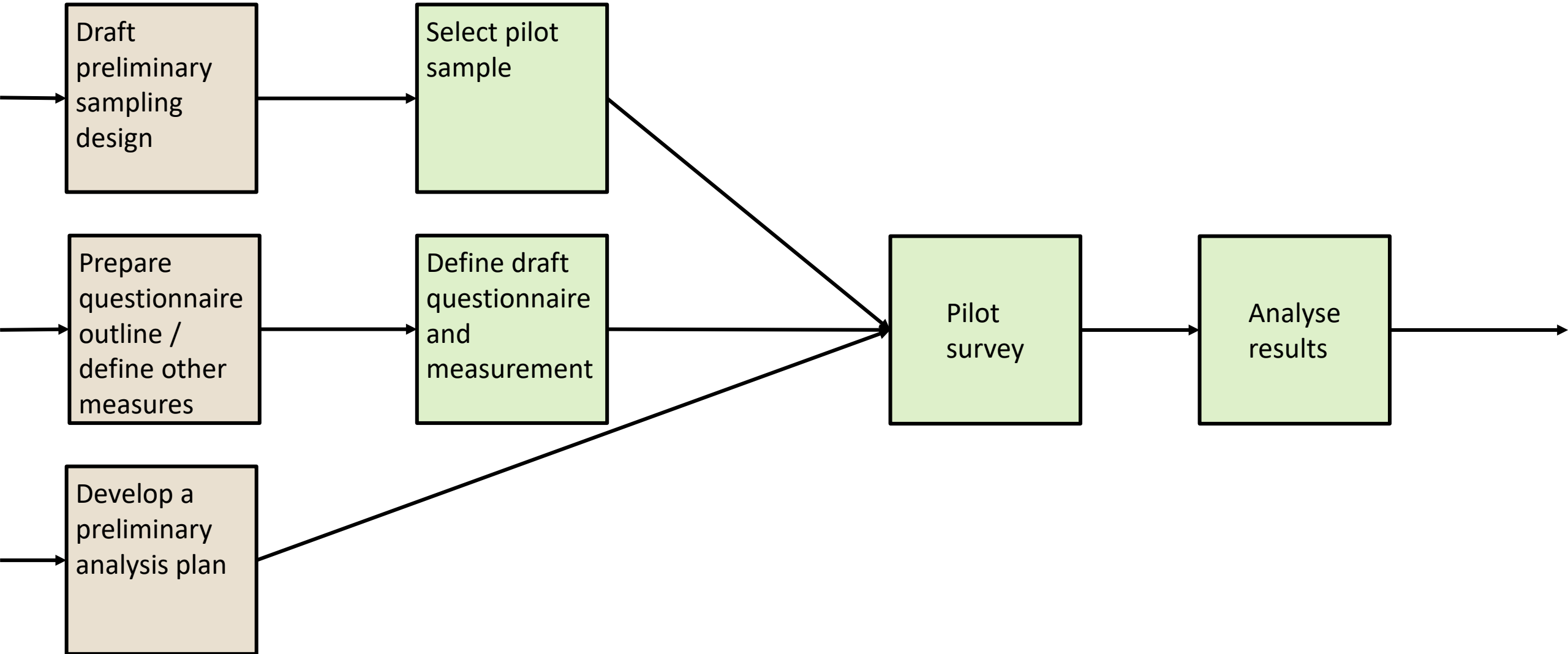
Steps in the survey process



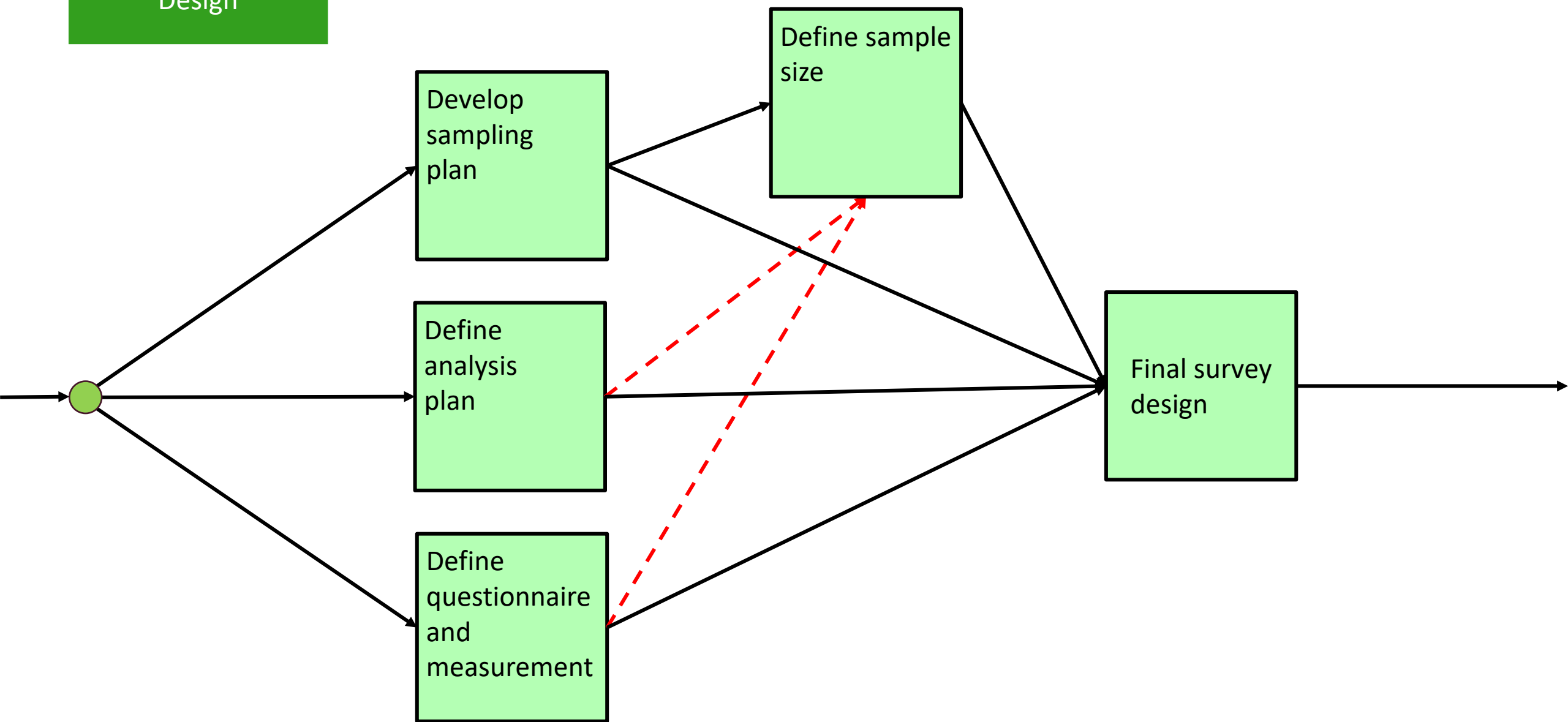
Planning



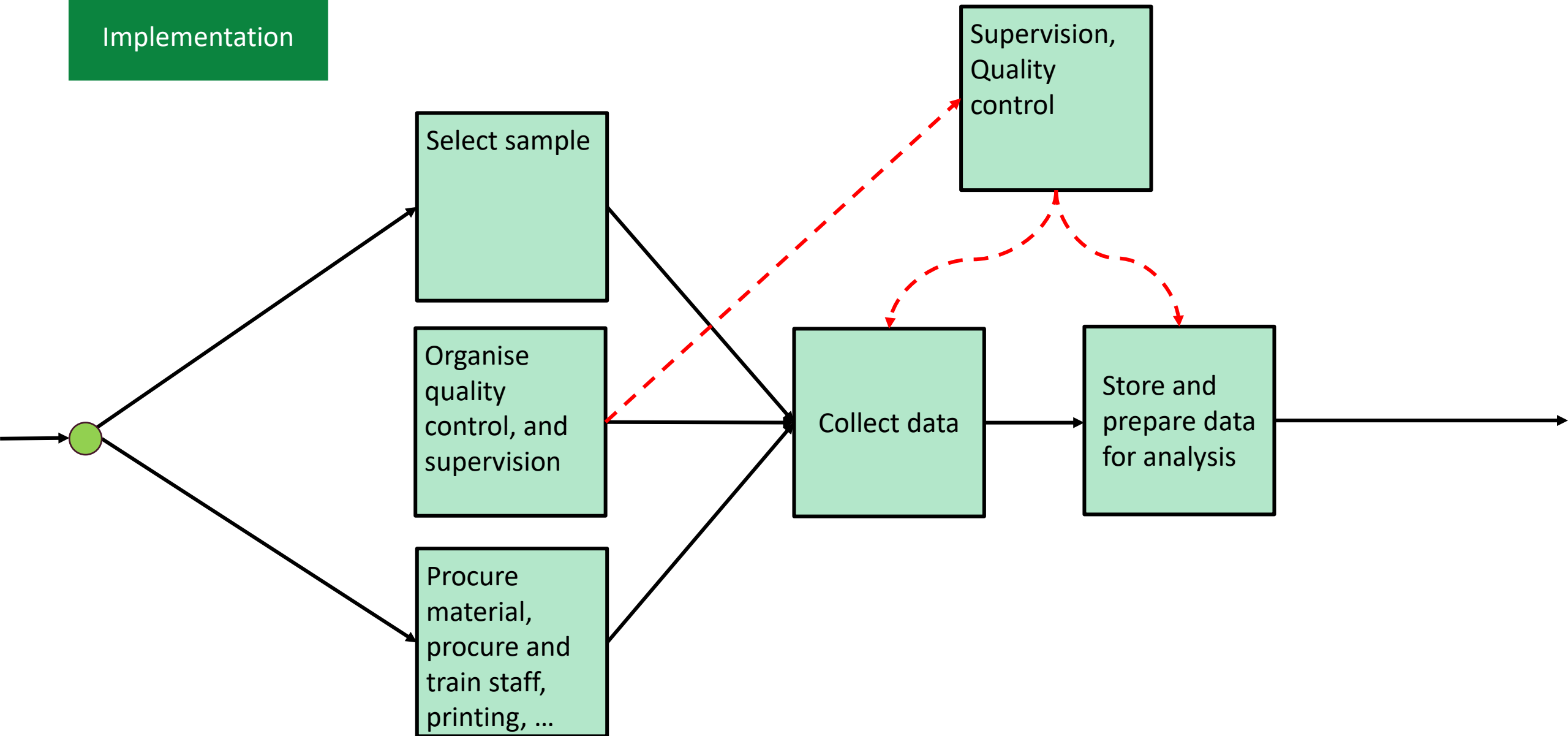
Piloting



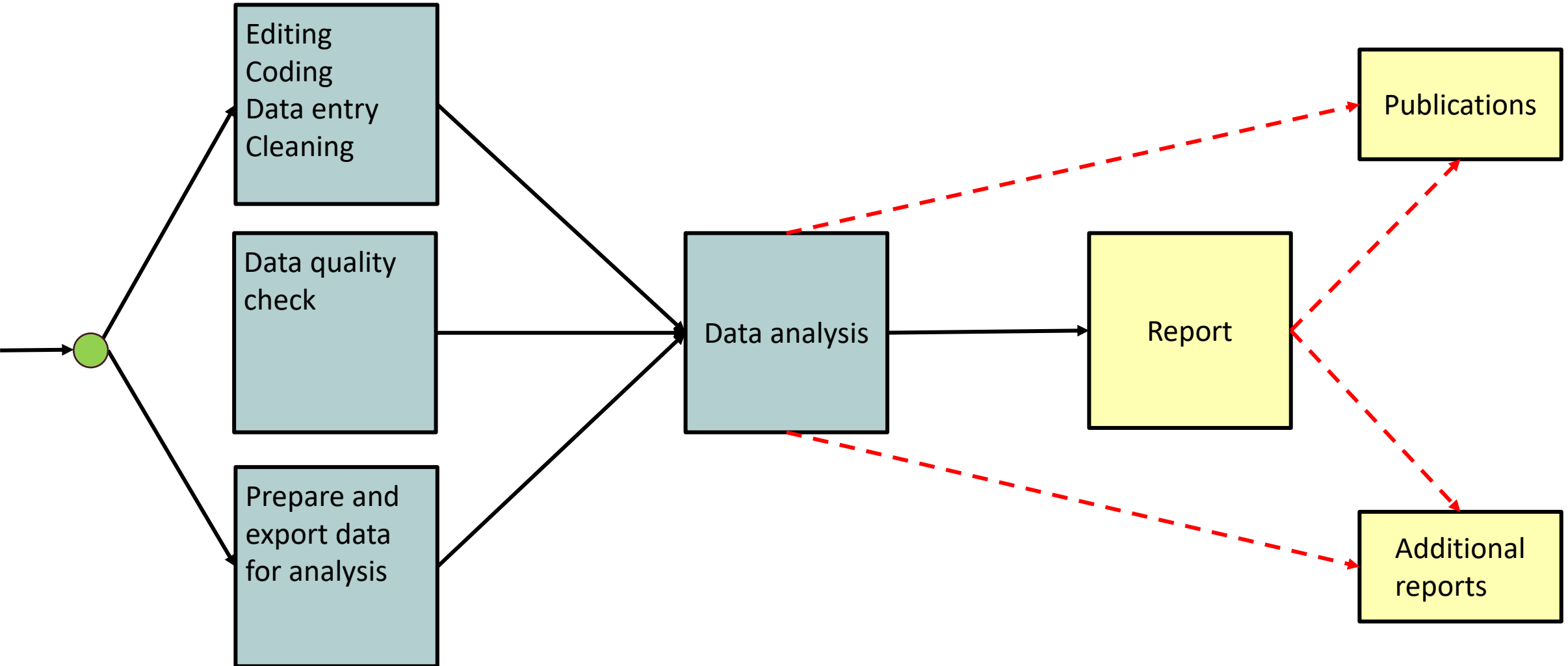
Design



Implementation



Data management and analysis



Research question

A research question is a specific inquiry which the research seeks to provide a response to. It resides at the core of systematic investigation and it helps you to clearly define a path for the research process.



Defines the method

Characteristics of a 'good' research questions

PICOT

population
intervention
comparator
outcome
time frame

FINER-MAPS

feasible
interesting
novel
ethical
relevant

Manageable
Appropriate
Publishable
Systematic

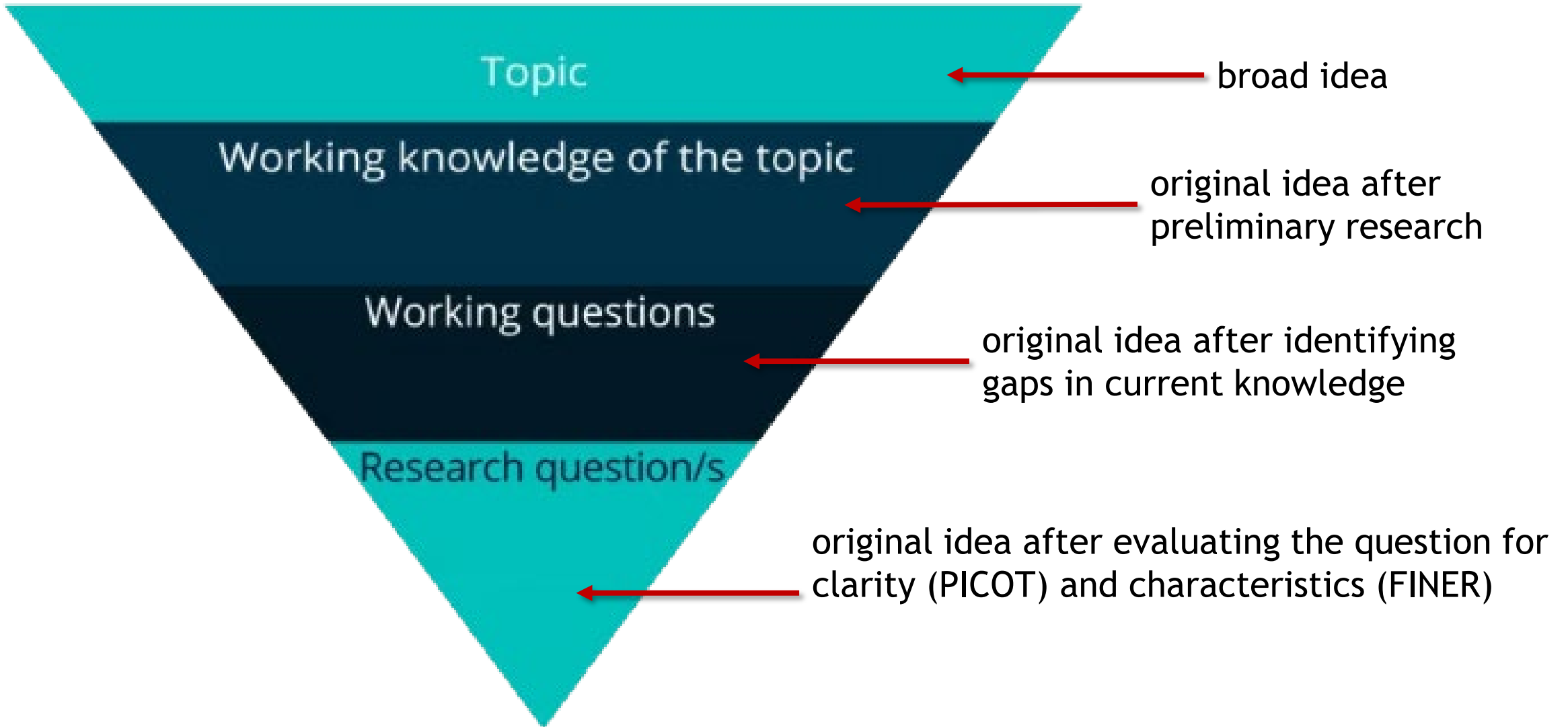
	A hit!	Do first-born children end up more financially successful?
	Close!	What effect does birth order have on children's success? (What type of success?)
	Miss!	Does birth order make a difference for children? (What kind of difference?)

	A hit!	What is the environmental impact of plastic water bottles?
	Close!	What is the impact of bottled water on the environment? (What aspect of bottled water?)
	Miss!	How does trash pollute the environment? (too broad: What kind of trash?)

	A hit!	Does drinking alcohol in college impact a student's GPA?
	Close!	What effect does alcohol have on college students? (What type of effect?)
	Miss!	Is alcohol harmful to young people? (What kind of harm? On who?)

Other examples (not all the same quality:
<https://slidesharetips.blogspot.com/2020/01/what-is-good-research-question-example.html>

Steps to write a research question



Aims

- What type of study are you doing: Is it descriptive or explanatory?
- What will be the main type of contribution of the study? Is it intended to make a practical, theoretical/conceptual or methodological advance?
- Is the study testing well-formulated hypotheses or simply asking a set of questions? What are they?
- How will the study add to what is already known?
- Are the ideas you are testing reasonable? Do they make sense in terms of previous research, theory and experience?
- Are the questions answerable or testable? Is it possible to measure the core concepts? Do you have access to a sample required for doing the study?

Context

- How does the study relate to previous research on the topic? Is it a replication, a test, an extension? What is different about it?
- How adequate is the previous research? What are the strengths and weaknesses of previous studies? Is there much previous research? Is the previous research consistent or are there conflicting findings and contradictions to be resolved?
- Have you **critically evaluated the previous research**? Your review of the research should not simply list what has been done. It should point out the gaps, limitations and other shortcomings. Does your research question emerge out of the shortcomings and gaps (empirical, theoretical or methodological) you have identified in the previous research? If it does not why are you doing the research?
- Have you examined the **most recent research**? How up to date is your review? Have you looked at books, reports, work in progress as well as journal articles?

Significance and scope

- Why is the study worth doing? Of what importance will the results be?
- What are the theories you will be evaluating? What concepts will you be using? Are these important?
- If you are evaluating theories are you clear what these theories are? Have you drawn a diagram of the theory?
- What is the scope of the study? Will the findings be widely generalisable? To which wider population or subgroups will the results apply?
- What will be your unit of analysis? Can you add to previous research by using different units of analysis?
- To what time period will the results apply? To what region(s) will the results apply?

Research design

- If you are conducting an explanatory study have you specified the type of research design you will be using?
- What comparison groups will you be using?
- Will your sample have sufficient diversity so that you can build comparison groups for data analysis? How will you make groups comparable?
- If you are looking at change do you have a time dimension to your study? Is the time over which you will look at change sufficient?
- Will you be using a prospective or retrospective approach?

Group 1: write a
research
question



Group 2: write a
research
question



10:00

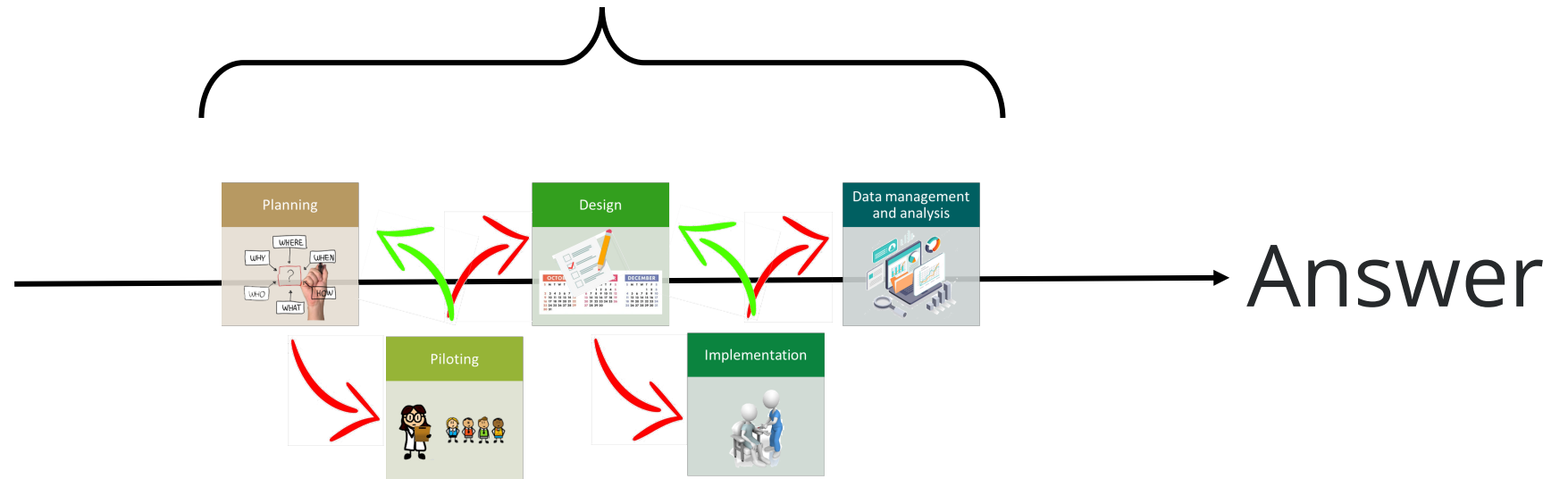
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Survey process

Research question



Survey protocol

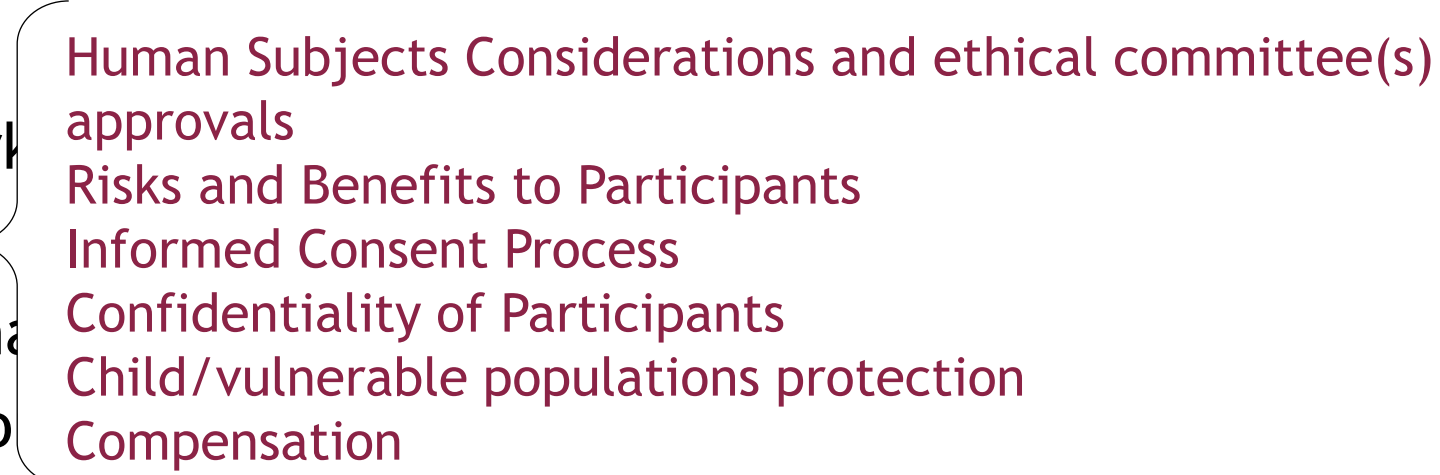
The survey protocol: outline

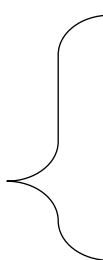
1. Background and rationale
2. Aims and objectives
3. Methods
4. Fieldwork
5. Ethics
6. Dissemination plan
7. Limitations
8. Timeline
9. Budget
10. References
11. Appendices

1. Background
2. Aims and objectives
3. **Methods**
4. Fieldwork
5. Ethics
6. Dissemination
7. Limitations
8. Timeline
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11. Appendices

- Study Design
- Study Population
- Sampling
 - Target population
 - Sampling strategy
 - Sample size calculation
- Data collection
- Measurements
 - Data collection tools
 - Data Collection Procedures
- Data management and analysis
- Data Quality Control
- Data Security
- Data Analysis
- Data Sharing

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- 
- Recruiting and Training of
fieldworkers and other personnel
Logistics and Supplies
Scheduling and Deployment of
Fieldwork

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- 
- Human Subjects Considerations and ethical committee(s)
approvals
Risks and Benefits to Participants
Informed Consent Process
Confidentiality of Participants
Child/vulnerable populations protection
Compensation

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- 
- Appendix 1: Consent Forms
 - Appendix 2: Survey Questionnaires
 - Appendix 3:

COHERENCE!

Background & rationale



Aims and objectives



Methods



Analysis

Lack of data on the
association
between depression
and poverty in
LMICs

Relationship between
depression and
poverty

a LMIC population
how to measure
poverty and
depression (directly or
indirectly)

how to analyse the
relationships between
depression and
poverty

Research paper

Simultaneous social causation and social drift: Longitudinal analysis of
depression and poverty in South Africa

Crick Lund^{a,b,*}, Annibale Cois^c

^a Alan J Flisher Centre for Public Mental Health, Department of Psychiatry and Mental Health, University of Cape Town, South Africa

^b Centre for Global Mental Health, Institute of Psychiatry, Psychology and Neuroscience, King's College London, United Kingdom

^c Division of Epidemiology and Biostatistics, School of Public Health and Family Medicine, University of Cape Town, South Africa



BMJ Open Study protocol for a nationwide questionnaire survey of physical activity among breast cancer survivors in Japan

Yoichi Shimizu,^{1,2} Katsunori Tsuji,¹ Eisuke Ochi,^{1,3} Hirokazu Arai,⁴ Ryo Okubo,¹
Aya Kuchiba,^{5,6} Taichi Shimazu ,⁷ Naomi Sakurai,⁸ Tomomi Narisawa,¹
Taro Ueno,⁹ Hiroji Iwata,¹⁰ Yutaka Matsuoka  ^{1,11}

(Shimizu et al. 2020)

Summary questions

- What are the steps in the survey process?
- Characteristics of good research questions
- How do you write a good research question?
- Criteria to evaluate research questions
- What is a survey protocol?

References

De Vaus, David. 2002. *Surveys in Social Research*. Allen & Unwin.

Fandino, Wilson. 2019. 'Formulating a Good Research Question: Pearls and Pitfalls'. *Indian Journal of Anaesthesia* 63 (8): 611–16. https://doi.org/10.4103/ija.IJA_198_19.

Shimizu, Yoichi, Katsunori Tsuji, Eisuke Ochi, Hirokazu Arai, Ryo Okubo, Aya Kuchiba, Taichi Shimazu, et al. 2020. 'Study Protocol for a Nationwide Questionnaire Survey of Physical Activity among Breast Cancer Survivors in Japan'. *BMJ Open* 10 (1): e032871. <https://doi.org/10.1136/bmjopen-2019-032871>.



Thank you

Annibale Cois

Education Building, 4th floor, Room 4060B

acois@sun.ac.za